



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Pusch Ridge Christian Academy

School Website: <https://www.prca.academy/#/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Pusch Ridge Christian Academy (PRCA) demonstrates a strong CLASSICAL, Christian educational identity across its public-facing materials. The school grounds its mission in a covenantal community centered on Christ, biblical worldview, and virtue formation, while organizing curriculum and pedagogy around classical aims (Great Books, Great Conversation, grammar-logic-rhetoric, and cultural-literature engagement). Evidence from PRCA's site and communications shows explicit commitments to: a biblical and theological frame for learning; the Great Books tradition and Great Conversation; the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); living books, Shakespeare and Cervantes, Latin beginnings, and Shakespeare festivals; a house-of-learning culture with memory work, recitations, and communal worship; and an intentional partnership with families through Covenant Parent Fellowship and other community programs. Taken together, these signals support a general assessment of PRCA as CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Key signals include: the mission statement describing a classical, Christian education within a covenantal community; pervasive biblical worldview integration across curriculum; explicit reference to Great Books and Great Conversation and a trivium-based pathway; lower- and upper-school rituals (recitations, memory work, chapel) and upper-school rhetoric/debate emphasis; living-books and Shakespeare/Cervantes study; and a strong emphasis on family-partnered formation (Covenant Parent Fellowship, Portrait of a Graduate). Public materials also describe a robust faculty and staff development posture and a clear parent-community partnership ethos. See citations for specific textual evidence drawn from PRCA's materials.

Executive summary category verdicts (across the six classical elements rubric) indicate CLASSICAL in each of the six categories. This yields an overall CLASSICAL assessment for PRCA.

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL
- Element 3 (Curriculum): CLASSICAL
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): CLASSICAL
- Element 5 (Faculty): CLASSICAL
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle section is not included here because the school is classified CLASSICAL across all six categories. If you'd like, I can propose targeted moves to reach a higher-degree CLASSICAL integration (e.g., deeper alignment to explicit liturgical practices in daily rhythm or broader communal rites), but no such needle-moving changes are strictly required to meet the classical rubric based on the current public materials.

ABSTRACT

ed evidence highlights and keyword signals are detailed under each category below, with keyword tallies and rubric-driven justifications.

- Foundational religious/metaphysical signals include explicit Christ-centered mission, covenantal language, biblical worldview integration, liturgical/community practices (chapel, worship), and explicit theological framing in statements of faith and conduct. See mission statements and Covenant Community materials.
- Purpose and goals emphasize virtue formation and truth-seeking as ends of education, not merely job preparation; the school frames education as formation and character maturation through a biblical worldview.
- Curriculum signals include Great Books, Great Conversation, grammar-logic-rhetoric (Trivium), living books, Shakespeare/Cervantes, Latin starting in Grade 3, and integration of Bible with all disciplines. Public materials explicitly discuss Great Books and Great Conversation as well as a literature-rich, living-book approach.
- Pedagogy signals include lower-school memory/recitations and singing, chapel and community rituals, and upper-school emphasis on rhetoric, debate, and seminars. The rhythms include memory verses, recitations, Shakespeare and literature-based study, and a rhetoric/debate emphasis for older students.
- Faculty signals include living-curriculum modeling, mentorship, faculty development, and a covenantal-community orientation, aligned with a portrait-of-graduate framework emphasizing virtue and learning. The school's description of faculty and leadership training, plus guidance and mentoring programs, supports a strong classical-faculty posture.
- Parents and community signals include Covenant Parent Fellowship, Parents as co-teachers orientation, and a strong partnership ethos with families (e.g., Covenant-Community statements, family involvement in academics, and fundraising/giving that supports the broader school mission).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission emphasizes Christ-centered, classical Christian education within a covenantal community.
- Biblical worldview integration across curriculum; theology-inflected framing for learning.
- Liturgical/community practices (Chapel, worship emphasis; covenantal language).
- Portrait-of-a-Graduate signals virtue-centered Christian formation (Truth Seekers, Servant Leaders).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: Christ, biblical worldview, covenantal, The Bible, chapel/worship, liturgical community, theology, Portrait of a Graduate (truth-seekers, servant leaders). Approximately 8–10 positive indicators observed.
- Negative keywords observed: None evident in public materials (no explicit vocational-education-leaning or non-liturgical terms that would contradict the foundation). Approximately 0 negative indicators.

Why this rating

- Strong explicit emphasis on Christian formation, biblical worldview, and liturgical/community life; alignment with transcendental moral realism and theological grounding. This category is clearly CLASSICAL in the PRCA public materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence



- Education framed as formation toward virtue and wisdom; truth, goodness, and beauty are real and knowable.
- Formation-centered objectives (virtue formation, character, habits of mind) and a covenantal aim for shaping hearts and minds.
- Portrait-of-a-Graduate signals concrete character aims (Truth Seekers, Courageous Christians, etc.).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, covenantal, formation, character, human excellence, God's design. Approximately 9–11 positive indicators.
- Negative keywords observed: none. 0 negative indicators.

Why this rating

- The school explicitly positions education as formation toward virtue and wisdom (not narrow job prep), with a biblical, transcendent frame. This aligns squarely with CLASSICAL aims of forming exemplary humans.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Liberal arts framing: Great Books and Great Conversation are foregrounded; living books and Western cultural heritage are integral.
- Trivium emphasis: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric embedded in curriculum (upper-level rhetoric, logic discussions, and oral civil discourse).
- Latin study beginning in Grade 3; Shakespeare, Cervantes, and Shakespeare Festival; living literature as core.
- History and literature integrated with Bible, science, art, and music; "Greats" highlight Truth, Goodness, Beauty.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: Great Books, Great Conversation, grammAR, logic, rhetoric, trivium, living books, Shakespeare, Cervantes, Latin, Shakespeare Festival, Western cultural heritage, Bible integration. Approximately 12–14 positive indicators.
- Negative keywords observed: none (no explicit terms that signaling non-classical, non-liberal-arts approaches). 0 negative indicators.

Why this rating

- The curriculum is explicitly framed around classical liberal arts (grammar-logic-rhetoric), Great Books and Great Conversation, literature-rich and historically grounded learning, and explicit Latin/Latin studies and Shakespeare/Cervantes. This is CLASSICAL by the standard rubric.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, memory work, recitations, and engaged memory-delighting routines (concrete, contemplative memory work).
- Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic or seminar-like discussions, debates, and rhetoric training (Rhetoric and Debate; opportunities to give speeches).
- Chapel, small groups, and community service in upper grades; a practical rhetorical skill-building environment (Rhetoric Showcase).
- Literature-based or living-book approach with Shakespeare/Cervantes and Shakespeare Festival; integration with other disciplines.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: singing/chanting (lower-school ritual), memory, recitations, chapel, small groups, rhetoric, debate, seminary-like seminars, public speaking, Great Books discussions. Approximately 9–12 positive indicators.
- Negative keywords observed: none (no explicit reliance on project-based or non-classical pedagogy). 0 negative indicators.

Why this rating

- Pedagogical methods align with classical expectations: contemplative/restful elements in parts, memory-centered lower-school practice, and Socratic/seminar/debate-oriented upper-school practice; plus a strong rhetorical/performing-arts emphasis. This supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty described as living curriculum and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; a covenantal, community-centered faculty culture.
- A professional development posture and a mentoring program to support teachers; formalized leadership training for new teachers.
- Clear portrait of what a teacher should be and what a student should be, with an emphasis on shared values and character.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, mentorship, professional development, leadership training, virtue, character, teachers as guardians of the mission. Approximately 8–10 positive indicators.
- Negative keywords observed: none.

Why this rating

- Faculty are presented as core to the curriculum and as mentors who embody the school's classical Christian mission; there is explicit emphasis on professional development and a "living curriculum" model. This is CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Covenant Parent Fellowship; explicit partnership with families; families as co-teachers with the school; texts about community and covenantal responsibility.
- The school discusses family involvement, shared commitments, and a broad community of believers (100 churches representation, etc.).
- PRCA's communications emphasize parent involvement, volunteerism, and community partnerships (Foundation Partners, Covenant Parent Fellowship, Lions Annual Fund, etc.).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: covenantal community, covenantal partnership, Covenant Parent Fellowship, co-educators, family involvement, community partnerships, parental engagement, Lions Annual Fund, Foundation Partners. Approximately 8–12 positive indicators.
- Negative keywords observed: none.

Why this rating

- The school explicitly foregrounds a robust parent/community partnership model and invites ongoing family involvement; this aligns with the CLASSICAL expectation of parents as co-teachers and a shared educational mission.

Overall aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The keyword signals across all six categories overwhelmingly align with classical education norms: biblical/theological grounding and covenantal community; virtue-centered formation; liberal-arts curriculum with Great Books/Great Conversation; grammar-logic-rhetoric pedagogy; living-curriculum faculty; and active parent/community partnership. The public materials consistently reflect these classical indicators with little to no explicit counter-indicators.

What would move the needle

- Since the aggregate is CLASSICAL, there is no mandated “Needle Move” section. If you wanted to push toward a more explicit early-adopter alignment with the full classical rubric (in a verifiable way beyond existing public materials), you could consider:
- Increasing explicit articulation of liturgical practices as integrated daily or weekly rituals (e.g., a stated liturgical schedule or formal liturgy elements across all campuses) to strengthen Liturgical/Communal Foundations in Element 1.
- Expanding explicit Socratic seminar design in lower grades (gradual Socratic discussion in K–8 with documented sample lesson plans) to strengthen Pedagogy in Element 4.
- Publishing more direct countertop metrics of Great Books literacy across grade bands (e.g., quantified Great Books targets per grade) to strengthen Curriculum signals in Element 3.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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